



CYBERSECURITY'S GLOBAL STAGE UNWRAPPED 2025

MARGARITA
RIVERA



JERICH
BEASON



DR. RUMMAN
CHOWDHURY



JAYA
BALOO



GARY
HAYSLIP



RICARDO
LAFOSSE



ANNE MARIE
ZETTLEMOYER



RICH
BAICH



THANK YOU TO OUR PARTNERS

Backed by the Kingdom's regulatory bodies and technology leaders, Black Hat MEA 2025 opened its doors for the fourth year in a row, welcoming over 500+ brands, 300+ global experts and 500+ participants for Guinness world record breaking, Capture the Flag.

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Tuwaiq Academy



BLACK HAT IN NUMBERS

THE NUMBERS BEHIND THE MOMENT

500+

industry-shaping
brands

300+

global experts sharing
what's next

200+

hours of breakthrough
thinking

500+

contestants competing
in Capture the Flag
challenges

50%

international startups

\$13.9 B

investor AUM

163 COUNTRIES. ONE RIYADH



ATTENDEE OVERVIEW



AUDIENCE & SENIORITY BREAKDOWN

44% senior decision makers

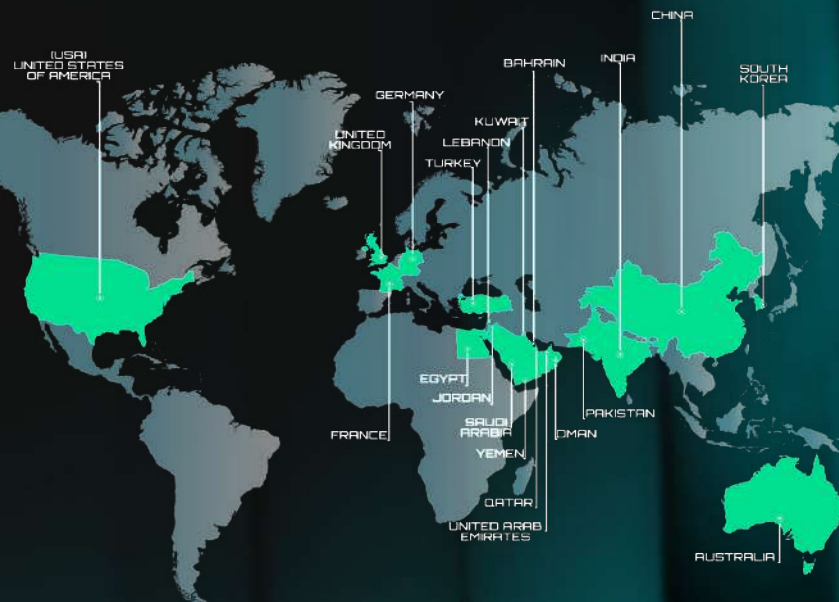
JOB FUNCTION BREAKDOWN OF SENIOR AUDIENCE

Senior	44%
Chairman / Board Member	7%
Owner / Board Director	1%
C-Level	9%
C-Level / President / Chairman	2%
Director / Head of Department / General Manager	6%
Director / VP	8%
Managing Director / Vice President	1%



70% of international attendees travelled from beyond the GCC region

VISITORS TRAVELING TO BLACK HAT MEA



60,000SQM OVERVIEW

Black Hat MEA 2025 featured a lineup of over 500 leading brands, showcasing their latest solutions and technologies, spanning the 60,000sqm show floor – where thousands of buyers came to explore the latest developments in cybersecurity, connect with the right partners, and build new business opportunities in the region.

2025'S EXHIBITING BRANDS INCLUDED:



Biggest cybersecurity event in the world - so important to have physical presence in the country to be on the ground and showcase our new solutions. The cybersecurity

community is here - in one place - where we can meet face to face.

DMITRY VOLKOV

Founder and CEO - Group IB

200 HOURS OF CONTENT

Across 3 days, 300+ global experts took to the 12 stages across the Black Hat MEA show floor. Infosec from leading global companies delivered 200+ hours of content with sessions covering the rapidly evolving threat landscape to the growing impact of AI as both a tool for defenders and a weapon for attackers – underscoring a shift from reactive defence to predictive, intelligent driven security – shaping the future of cybersecurity in the Middle East and beyond.

Hear from the Black Hat Hall of fame



It was a genuine pleasure to speak at Black Hat MEA 2025. The energy, curiosity, and professionalism at the event made the conversation meaningful in a way that many conferences don't achieve. The event stands out for its mix of deep technical expertise and open, strategic discussion on leadership, risk and resilience. I left inspired by the community and grateful to have played a part in it. As I shared on stage: "Plans fail, but those who plan succeed." Black Hat MEA is one of the rare platforms where that mindset isn't just quoted, it's operationalised.

CRAIG MCEWEN,
Global CISO, Dechra



BH MEA 2025 surpassed my expectations. The event was much larger and more engaging than I'd expected. I loved getting to catch up with old friends, and make many new friends from the Middle East region. I'd happily attend this again.

DANIEL BOWDEN,
MMC Global Business CISO,
Marsh



Black Hat MEA delivered an exceptional experience world-class content, inspiring speakers, and flawless execution. The attention to detail, professionalism, and hospitality set a new standard for global cybersecurity events. It was an honor to participate in a conference that truly brings the community together and showcases the future of cyber innovation.

MARGARITA RIVERA,
Global Chief Information
Security Officer,
Carnival Corporation

2025 HALL OF FAME



GARY HAYSLIP

CISO-In-Residence

Halcyon



TRINA FORD

CISO

iHeartMedia



DEVON BRYAN

Global Chief Security Officer

Booking Holdings



RUMMAN CHOWDHURY

Founder & CEO

Humane Intelligence



MARK THURMOND

CO-CEO

Tenable



CHARLES FORTE

Director General Chief Information Security Officer

Ministry of Defence, UK



STEFAN BALOUS

Chief Information Security Officer

Hugo Boss



JAYA BALOO

COO & CISO

AISLE



RICH BAICH

Chief Information Security Officer

AT&T



TIMOTHY LEE

Chief Information Security Officer

City of Los Angeles



ALISSA ABDULLAH

Do Chief Security Officer

Mastercard



TEMI ADEBAMBO

Chief Information Security Officer

XBOX



JAMEEKA GREEN-AARON

Chief Information Security Officer

Headspace



RICARDO LAFOSSE

Chief Information Security Officer

Kraft Heinz



J. NICOLE DOVE

Head of Security, Games

Riot Games



DAN MERCHAM

Chief Information Security Officer

Legendary Entertainment



DR. CHENXI WANG

Managing General Partner

Rain Capital



BJORN WATNE

Global CISO

INTERPOL



JERICH BEASON

Chief Information Security Officer

WM



MARGARITA RIVERA

Global Chief Information Security Officer

Carnival Corporation

FEATURES



EXECUTIVE SUMMIT

The Executive Summit at Black Hat MEA 2025 convened 75+ global CISOs and senior leaders from government and industry, creating a highly curated platform for strategic dialogue. With 75% international representation and a 25% YoY growth in CISO participation, the summit focused on real-world challenges, cross-sector collaboration, and forward-looking cybersecurity strategies at the highest level.



BRIEFINGS

Briefings showcased cutting-edge cybersecurity research, with a 35% YoY increase in submissions and 155 sessions delivered across the programme. Featuring a mix of globally recognised experts and emerging voices, the track delivered deep insights into vulnerabilities, threat landscapes, and breakthrough research shaping the industry.



WORKSHOPS

CISO Workshops offered highly focused, small-group sessions designed for senior cybersecurity leaders, with an average of 30 participants per session. The format enabled deeper peer-to-peer discussions, practical problem-solving, and meaningful knowledge exchange, resulting in strong engagement and consistently full participation.

FEATURES



THE BLACK HAT FILES

The Black Hat Files marked the launch of a new content series, recorded live from The Back Room - the on-site podcast studio. Streaming the Daily Wrap-Up segment live on LinkedIn at 4:00 PM each day, the series captured real-time insights and candid conversations with speakers, extending the reach of the conference beyond the show floor to a global audience.



ACTIVITY ZONE

From digital forensics to ship hacking, the Black Hat MEA Activity Zone featured 11 interactive zones for attendees to test their luck in real word hacking experiences.



CAPTURE THE FLAG

The world's largest capture the flag event

Held from December 2-4, 2025, featuring 500 participants and a 1,000,000 SAR prize pool.

FEATURES



CARPOOL

Carpool introduced a fresh, informal content format, featuring candid conversations with speakers filmed en route to the venue in a branded cyber truck. The series quickly became a high-demand experience, adding a dynamic and personality-driven layer to Black Hat MEA's content ecosystem.



WOMEN IN FOCUS

Women in Focus reflected one of the highest levels of female participation in cybersecurity events globally, contributing to 29% overall female representation across the conference. Bringing together a strong mix of international experts and regional leaders, the platform created meaningful conversations around inclusion, leadership, and the role of diverse talent in shaping the future of cybersecurity.



ARSENAL

Arsenal delivers a curated showcase of the latest open-source security tools and research, presented through live, hands-on demonstrations, with a 103% YoY increase in 2025 in the number of submissions. Attendees can explore newly released tools and engage directly with their creators.

FEATURES



FINANCIAL SUMMIT

Launched for the first time in 2025, the Financial Services Summit introduced a dedicated platform focused on one of the most targeted and rapidly evolving sectors. Bringing together leaders from banking, fintech, and financial institutions, it enabled focused discussions on sector-specific threats, regulatory pressures, and resilience strategies.



BLACK HAT CAMPUS

Black Hat Campus created a meaningful bridge between industry leaders and emerging talent, giving CISOs the opportunity to directly contribute to the development of the next generation. Through one-on-one conversations and knowledge sharing, it fostered mentorship and deeper engagement with future cybersecurity professionals.



ECOSYSTEM POWER HOUR

Power Hour is a private, invite-only networking experience to convene the most influential voices shaping cybersecurity innovation. Bringing together cybersecurity founders, VCs and angel investors, ecosystem enablers and innovation leaders for a focused hour of high-value connections. Through curated one-on-one interactions, Power Hour enables insight exchange, deal flow exploration and collaboration opportunities all within a highly efficient, outcomes-driven setting.

ANNOUNCEMENTS

REAL DEALS.
REAL ANNOUNCEMENTS.
REAL IMPACT.

proofpoint.

GATEWATCHER

rubrik

ECHELON
DIGITAL

FITS
AL KHALIJ

حلول القيادة
LEADERS SOLUTIONS

infoblox

CIPHER

DARKTRACE

salam

FRINGE EVENTS

BHMEA EXCLUSIVE SPEED NETWORKING EVENT:



2nd December 2026



7pm – 11pm



TeleIOS Riyadh

ATTENDEES: 50 VVIP

The evening was designed to inspire meaningful conversations and valuable connections, over F1 simulator experience.

An exclusive, invite-only evening reserved for selected speakers, from ministry level, to VIPs, CEOs, founders. offering premium canapés, signature mocktails, music, and an luxurious F1 simulator competition where our guests showcased their speed and skills.



FRINGE EVENTS

AFTER-HOURS BY BLACK HAT:



3rd December 2026



7pm – 10pm



Chotto Matte KAFD

300 (SPEAKERS, INVESTORS AND PARTNERS)

After-Hours by Black hat Set in the heart of KAFD, After-Hours by Black Hat offered an intimate Japanese dining experience curated for 300 select speakers, investors, and partners. The evening combined premium canapés, signature mocktails, and diverse entertainment elements to create an engaging space for conversation and connection.



INVESTOR PROGRAM

The program recorded **99 investor registrations**
Participating firms represented a combined
\$14 billion in Assets Under Management (AUM)
With investors joining from **14 unique countries**.

67% KSA-based investors

33% international investors

The program delivered structured, high-value engagement opportunities including:



105 minutes of dedicated investor-focused stage content



60-minute Power Hour networking session



Black Hat Middle East is no longer just a regional conference - it is a global platform for cybersecurity innovation, leadership, and execution. As a speaker and CyberSeed startup competition judge, I was deeply impressed by the quality of innovation, the ambition of founders, and the speed at which meaningful business conversations turned into action.

ANSHU GUPTA
SVC



I've heard some incredible things about Blackhat over the last couple of years so I thought I would check it out in 2025. It's safe to say it exceeded expectations, both with the panels and with the exhibitors. I managed to come away from my day there with some great knowledge gained as well with several new contacts that have led to new opportunities 2026.

REECE TOLWORTHY
CEA MENA

TOP FIRMS-

impact46

1957
Ventures

VISION
VENTURES

Merak.Capital

ONE
GLOBAL
HOLDING

WAED
by aramco

SEEDRA
VENTURES

S^v sukna
ventures

BECO

RAN CAPITAL

STARTUPS & SCALEUP PROGRAM

THE WORLD'S STRONGEST CYBER FOUNDERS APPLIED

LESS THAN **40%** ACCEPTANCE

57% INTERNATIONAL STARTUPS

WITH OVER **\$48M+** IN FUNDS
RAISED

TOTAL CYBERSEED FINALISTS: **10**

6 UNIQUE COUNTRIES REPRESENTED
AMONGST THE **10** FINALISTS

WITH OVER **\$12M+** IN FUNDS RAISED

CYBERSEED AWARD WINNER: Sahl, (Founder: Ayesha Mansha)



STARTUPS AT BLACK HAT MEA 2025



CYBERSEED PITCH COMPETITION

BLACK HAT CYBERSEED STARTUPS:



Eleen

APEXAI



Sahl | سهل

FORTIVERA

OCTOPUS
CYBERSECURITY

MAKTIV.AI

secolve
THE OT SECURITY SPECIALISTS

RASPIRE

JUDGES:



HAITAM BU-AISHA

Managing Partner,
Vision Ventures



CHENXI WANG

Managing General
Partner, Rain Capital



ANSHU GUPTA

Chief Information Security
Officer, Silicon Valley
CISO Investments (SVCI)



PR OVERVIEW



1.5 K

PIECES OF COVERAGE

Total number of online, offline and social clips in this report



249M

AUDIENCE

Combined total of publication-wide audience figures for all outlets featuring coverage



5.85M

ESTIMATED VIEWS

Prediction of lifetime views of coverage, based on audience reach & engagement rate on social



1.67K

ENGAGEMENTS

Combined total of likes, comments and shares on social media



BLACK HAT MEA

1-3 DECEMBER 2026

INTRODUCING...

TWO WORLDS

KiNGDOM
— OF GAMING —


black hat[®]
MIDDLE EAST AND AFRICA

ONE
DIGITAL
FUTURE

CYBERSECURITY IS NO LONGER ADJACENT TO GAMING, IT'S FOUNDATIONAL.

Co-locating with Black Hat MEA means:



Access to the region's
most advanced
security thinkers



Shared audiences
across cloud, infra,
data, and DevSecOps



A bridge between
game development
and secure digital
economies



A powerful alignment
with national digital
ambitions



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STRATEGIC

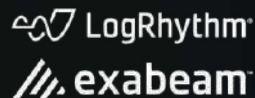
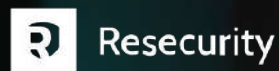


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Cyber
الشركة السعودية للأمن الإلكتروني
Saudi Cybersecurity Company



CYBER
CUBE



netskope



COMMUNITY PARTNER



Women in Cyber Security Middle East
رابطة نساء الأمن الإلكتروني في الشرق الأوسط

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